The Kitchen-Table Test

What could your household actually eat for seven days if stores and power were unavailable?

Sit down with the people who live in your house. Using only what's already in your kitchen, plan seven days of meals. Mark each meal by how it's prepared:

N = no-cook **L** = low-fuel (hot water or a short heat) **F** = full-cook (real fuel and time). Any outdoor cooking stays outdoors.

Household at a Glance	
People eating here: _____	**Infants / formula needs:** _____
Dietary or medical diets: _____	**Pets and their food:** _____
Safe backup cooking method: _____	**Manual can openers (aim for 2):** _____

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks
1	N L F	N L F	N L F	
2	N L F	N L F	N L F	
3	N L F	N L F	N L F	
4	N L F	N L F	N L F	
5	N L F	N L F	N L F	
6	N L F	N L F	N L F	
7	N L F	N L F	N L F	

Three Meals That Need No Electricity

Set these aside, label them, and leave them alone except during rotation.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

The Gaps We Found

These aren't a reason for fear. They're your shopping list. Add three shelf-stable items your family already eats on each of your next four trips.

Trip 1	Trip 2	Trip 3	Trip 4
☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐	☐

THE RESILIENT HOUSEHOLD · PART 1 COMPANION

Monthly Shelf Audit

Fifteen minutes, once a month. Store what you eat, eat what you store.

Task	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Moved anything near its date to the front, and planned a meal around it												
New groceries placed behind older ones, purchase month written on lids												
Discarded bulging, leaking, rusted, or seam-dented cans (no taste tests)												
Checked flour, grains, and paper packages for pests or moisture												
Confirmed the three no-electricity meals are still intact												
Checked formula and baby food use-by dates (if applicable)												
Pet food supply checked												
Fridge at 40°F or below, freezer at 0°F or below												
Battery CO alarm tested												
Used items added to the shopping list; share shelf topped up												

Layer progress:

☐ Everyday pantry ☐ Two-week buffer ☐ Thirty-day deep pantry ☐ Longer-term staples & local

Build the layers in order. The foundation carries the weight.

✂ *cut along the dashed line and tape inside a cabinet door*

When the Freezer Fails

Power-outage food safety at a glance

Keep the doors closed. Every opening costs cold.

Refrigerator: about 4 hours safe without power

Full freezer: about 48 hours (half-full: about 24)

Safe temperatures: fridge 40°F or below, freezer 0°F or below

The 2-hour rule: perishables above 40°F for over 2 hours go out

Eat in this order: fridge first, freezer second, pantry last

Never cook indoors: grills and camp stoves stay outside. CO kills.

When in doubt, throw it out.

Source: USDA food-safety guidance · The Faithful Remnant